SOP-QC-014: Stability testing, expiry dating and reserve samples (synthetic)

Version 3 Effective 01-Jul-2026 Department: Quality Control Site: Chennai

1. Purpose

To define how stability studies are planned and run, how expiry dates are assigned and printed, and how reserve samples of finished product are kept, for products made at the Chennai site.

2. Scope

Applies to commercial batches of tablets and capsules. It does not apply to sterile products, products reconstituted before use, homeopathic products, allergenic extracts, radioactive drugs or investigational products.

3. Responsibilities

The QC manager writes and approves each stability protocol. QA approves the protocol, reviews every stability report and owns this procedure. Stores keeps the retention room.

4. Stability programme

4.1 Every product has a written stability protocol, approved by QA, and the protocol is followed for every batch placed on study. 4.2 The protocol states how many units are pulled at each time point, chosen statistically for each attribute tested, and the test intervals: 0, 3, 6, 9, 12, 18, 24 and 36 months. 4.3 Samples are stored in qualified chambers at 30 C / 75% RH (long term) and 40 C / 75% RH (accelerated); chamber conditions are logged every 15 minutes. 4.4 Only validated, stability-indicating test methods are used (SOP-QC-002). 4.5 Stability samples are packed in the same container-closure system as the marketed product. 4.6 At least three production batches of each product are placed on stability, and every result is recorded in the stability database.

5. Expiry dating

5.1 The expiry date of each product is set from its long-term stability data and is printed on every label. For a new product, a tentative expiry date of 24 months may be set from six months of accelerated data. 5.2 The label states the storage condition the expiry date depends on, for example Store below 30 C, protect from moisture. 5.3 The expiry date appears on the label in the form required by 21 CFR 201.17.

6. Reserve samples

6.1 An identified reserve sample, representative of each batch of finished product, is kept in its market pack in the retention room at the storage condition on the label. 6.2 Each reserve sample holds at least twice the quantity needed for full release testing. 6.3 Reserve samples are kept until six months after the expiry date of the batch, then destroyed under QA witness.

7. Records

Stability protocols, results, reports and the retention room log are kept for the life of the product plus one year.